



Key Interventions

- › Establish **two** day care centres with improved child care and pre-schooling facilities for the children of the workers
- › Establish **one** primary school for the workers' children
- › Establish **one** legal aid clinic on the factory premise to provide legal support to the workers
- › Develop **100** health volunteers through capacity building on sexual and reproductive health and rights, personal hygiene and behavior, maternal health, family planning etc.
- › Develop **220** workers as 'Gender Equality Promoters' for demonstrating gender issues within the workplace and household, and taking measures to address those.
- › Capacitate **10** workers as human rights and legal education (Human Rights and Legal Education) Shebikas through training on human rights and legal aid services curriculum.
- › Train **240** workers as the members of Odhikar Bastobayon Committee for promoting peer support to co-workers on legal issues.
- › Develop capacity of **2,400** workers through conducting Human Rights and Legal Education classes
- › Provide gender training to management staff of Echotex for establishing gender-responsive workplace.
- › Develop a gender policy for Echotex to ensure gender-responsive work environment on factory premises.

Why BRAC?

BRAC brings practical experience, knowledge and skills in capacity building and working with the community, government entities, the private sector, and industry associations in Bangladesh. The organisation has a track record of 46 years of large-scale successful initiatives in a wide range of sectors that advance Bangladesh.

Organisational Profile:

BRAC

BRAC is a global leader in developing cost-effective, evidence-based programmes, and has been ranked the #1 NGO in the world consecutively for the last four years by NGO Advisor. BRAC uses an integrated model of social development programmes, humanitarian response, social enterprises, socially responsible investments and a university. The organisation operates in 11 countries across Asia and Africa.

Echotex

Echotex is a leading Bangladeshi vertical setup with facilities for knitting, dyeing, digital and screen printing, laundry and garmenting. Keeping the planet, people and product at the heart, Echotex focuses on efficiency, productivity and workers' welfare. Echotex actively promotes gender-friendly work environment, maternity and paternity leave, legal aid, child day care facilities and pre-primary education for its workers.

For more information Please contact
gjd.communication@brac.net



BRAC
BRAC Centre, 75 Mohakhali
Dhaka 1212, Bangladesh
T: +880 2 9881265 F: +880 2 8823542
E: info@brac.net W: www.brac.net

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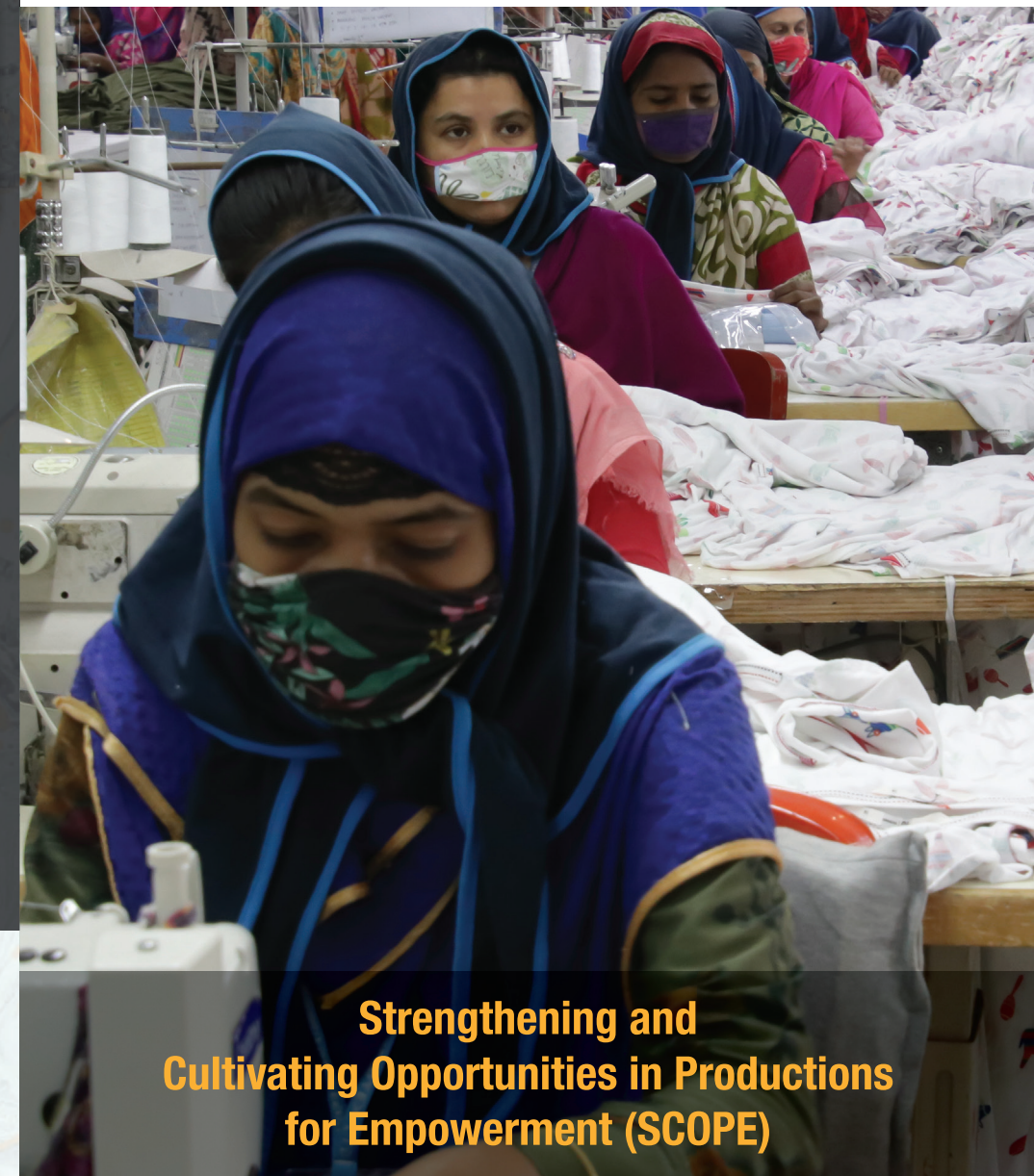
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ECOTEX
Planet People Product



**Strengthening and
Cultivating Opportunities in Productions
for Empowerment (SCOPE)**

A Partnership Project between Echotex Ltd. and BRAC

Project Background

The ready-made garment (RMG) industry has been dubbed as the largest export-earning sector in Bangladesh, contributing significantly to the country's exchequer. More than 5,000 garment factories are currently operating in the sector, employing over four million people and more than 80 per cent of the workforce are women. However, restrictive gender stereotypes still persist at homes as well as in the workplaces despite the visible transformation in the gender composition of the national labour force.¹

With an aim to creating an enabling working environment for women garment workers, BRAC Gender Justice and Diversity (GJD) Programme has been implementing the SCOPE (Strengthening and Cultivating Opportunities in Productions for Empowerment) project since 2017 with the financial support by Echotex, a leading ready-made garment factory in Bangladesh.

This project is being implemented through a joint collaboration of BRAC Human Rights and Legal Aid Services (HRLS), BRAC Education Programme (BEP) and Health, Nutrition and Population Programme.

¹Farhana, K., et al. (2015). "Present Status of Workers in Ready-Made Garments Industries in Bangladesh." European Scientific Journal 11(7).

Goal:

To create a violence-free and gender-responsive work environment for the garment workers in order to increase their productivity and unleash the full potential that contributes to the national economy to a greater extent.

Objectives

The overall objective of the project is to build a model in Echotex through enhancing the existing work environment and service delivery process for workers that can be replicated in other garments in the long run. The specific objectives are as follows:

- › Enhance service delivery for workers regarding day care centre, health, education and legal aid services
- › Promote decent work environment
- › Enhance leadership capacity of women workers
- › Create evidence for national-level advocacy

Key Information

Project area :
Echotex, Kaliakoir, Gazipur

Project period :
Three (3) years
[April 2017 to March 2020]

Project participants :
Workers of Echotex;
Direct – **2,400** workers
Indirect – **8,000** workers their family members and community people

